

SANTHOSH KUMAR KANNAN

Chennai, India (Open to Relocate to Germany)

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Summary

Head of Data Engineering with 17 years across enterprise data platforms, analytics and generative AI. Leads cross-functional teams in HR, GBS and finance to build trusted Snowflake and AWS data products with low latency, high data quality and GDPR/SOX-aligned governance. Turns business questions into scalable, well-modelled solutions, standardises engineering practices and prepares organisations to adopt generative AI safely on governed data.

Core Skills

- **Data Leadership and Strategy:** Data platform vision, roadmap ownership, senior stakeholder management
- **Cloud and DevOps:** AWS data stack, CI/CD for data, GitHub workflows, monitoring, incident management
- **Delivery and Governance:** Agile delivery, cross-functional alignment, vendor management, audit and compliance reporting
- **GenAI and Analytics:** Natural language analytics, RAG architectures, LLM application design, semantic search, prompt engineering
- **Data Platforms and Engineering:** Snowflake architecture, dimensional modelling, domain data products, ELT/ETL pipelines
- **Data Governance and Security:** HR and finance data, KPI frameworks, GDPR and SOX controls, RBAC and secure data access

Experience

AstraZeneca

August 2018 – Present

Lead Consultant – Data Engineering and GenAI

Chennai, India

- Own HR and GBS Snowflake data platform on AWS for global analytics, partnering with HR, GBS and finance leadership teams.
- Reengineer Snowpipe and micro batch pipelines and tune compute clusters to cut refresh latency by about 70% and stabilise SLAs.
- Standardise domain data products, metrics, CI/CD and code reviews and lift deployment reliability and productivity for 50+ engineers.
- Deliver NLQ bot, RAG BAU assistant and glossary generator under GDPR and SOX controls and reduce manual effort and incidents by about 30%.

Systech Solutions

January 2015 – August 2018

Delivery Manager – Data Engineering

Chennai, India

- Directed end-to-end data engineering programmes for insurance, telecom and retail clients in India and the United States, managing up to 30 engineers.
- Led migration of Talend pipelines to Teradata procedures, improving batch performance by about 20% and lowering support workload.
- Developed reusable ingestion and transformation frameworks and cut new pipeline build time by about 30%, raising reuse across projects.

Virtusa	April 2014 – December 2014
<i>Tech Lead – Data Engineering</i>	<i>Chennai, India</i>
Implemented reusable ETL subsystems and scheduling patterns and cut development time and incident noise by about 15% in production for banking and financial clients.	
Fulcrum Logic	January 2013 – February 2014
<i>Talend Engineer – Data Integration</i>	<i>United Kingdom</i>
- Delivered data integration solutions for the ONS Trailblazers initiative using Talend ETL and Liferay across multiple source systems. - Improved data consistency and availability for ONS Trailblazers datasets for several upstream sources and internal analytics users.	
Symphony Advanced Media	April 2011 – December 2012
<i>Senior Software Engineer – Data Engineering</i>	<i>Bengaluru, India</i>
- Built Talend pipelines for media measurement domains, including TMS, Kantar and Vision Critical, with strict timeliness targets. - Managed scheduling and monitoring through Talend Administration Centre and reduced failed job incidents and recovery times.	
Ness Technologies	October 2009 – April 2011
<i>Software Engineer – Data Engineering</i>	<i>Bengaluru, India</i>
Developed and maintained Talend ETL jobs and data models for airline PNR and departure control system feeds in production.	
Systech Solutions	December 2006 – October 2009
<i>Technologist – Data Engineering and BI Developer</i>	<i>Chennai, India</i>
Implemented ETL pipelines on Netezza for enterprise clients and supported large analytical workloads with tight load windows.	

Education

St. Joseph's College	2003 – 2006
<i>Master of Computer Applications (MCA)</i>	<i>Trichy, India</i>
St. Joseph's College	2000 – 2003
<i>Bachelor of Science in Physics</i>	<i>Trichy, India</i>

Certifications

- Snowflake SnowPro Core Certification – Snowflake
- AWS Certified Solutions Architect Associate – Amazon Web Services
- Advanced Certification on Generative AI – UpGrad

Languages

- English – Full Professional Proficiency (C1)
- German – Intermediate Working Proficiency (B1)